CARDIFF UNIVERSITY
EXAMINATION PAPER

Academic Year :	2017-2018
Examination Period :	Spring
Examination Paper Number :	MA 0367
Examination Paper Title :	Time Series Analysis and Forecasting

Do not turn this page over until instructed to do by the Senior Invigilator.

Structure of Examination Paper:

There are Five pages.
There are FOUR questions in total.
There are no appendices.
The mark obtainable for each question is 25.

Students to be provided with:

The following items of stationery are to be provided at the start of the examination:
One answer book.

Instructions to Students:

Answer **THREE** questions

The use of a translation dictionary between English or Welsh and another language, provided that it bears an appropriate departmental stamp, is permitted in this examination.

Question 1

(i) Give the definition of the Poisson process.

[2]

(ii) Explain how to compute the correlation function $\rho(k)$, $k = 1, 2, 3, \ldots$, for an AR(p) process with known coefficients using Yule-Walker equations.

[3]

(iii) Write the R code for computing the periodogram of a realization of length 90 from the white noise process with mean 3.4 and variance 5 using the Fourier transform.

[3]

(iv) Consider the time series $x_k = 2\sin(13\pi k/19) + \sin(11\pi k/16) + 3\sin(8\pi k/13)$, $k \in \mathbb{Z}$, and the filter with spectrum $f(\lambda) = 1_{[0.66\pi, 0.7\pi]}(\lambda)$, $\lambda \in (0, \pi)$. Find the filtered series and its spectrum.

[2]

(v) Consider the time series $x_1 = 23$, $x_2 = 28$, $x_3 = 24$ and assume that the observations correspond to a stationary normal process with covariance function $R(k) = \frac{2}{1+\sqrt{|k|}}$. Compute the best linear predictor for x_6 and also the prediction bounds for x_6 with confidence level $1 - \alpha$.

[6]

(vi) Suppose that a time series $x_1, \ldots, x_{60}$ is described by an AR(2) process $x_t - a_1 x_{t-1} - a_2 x_{t-2} = \epsilon_t$, where ϵ_t is white noise. Suppose also that estimators of the covariance function are $\hat{R}(0) = 10$, $\hat{R}(1) = 7.2$ and $\hat{R}(2) = 1.6$. Find estimators of the parameters of the AR(2) process: the coefficients a_1, a_2, and the noise variance $\sigma^2 = \mathrm{Var}(\epsilon_t)$.

[5]

(vii) Find the covariance function for a discrete weakly stationary process x_t with spectral density $f(\lambda) = 4 + \lambda^2$.

[4]

Question 2

(i) Explain the procedure of filtration of time series in temporal and spectral domains.

[2]

(ii) Suppose that x_t is a strictly stationary process and $\mathbf{E}x_t^2 < \infty$. Show that x_t is a stationary process, in the wide sense.

[4]

(iii) Write the R code for simulating and depicting a realization of the Poisson process.

[3]

(iv) Is the covariance function $R(k) = \frac{3}{(4+|k|^{2.75})^{0.35}}$, $k \in \mathbb{Z}$, short-range or long-range dependent? Explain your answer.

[2]

(v) Consider the causal AR(3) process $x_t = 0.8x_{t-1} - x_{t-2} + 0.5x_{t-3} + \epsilon_t$, where ϵ_t is white noise, $t \in \mathbb{Z}$. Find the coefficients c_0, c_1, c_2, c_3, c_4 of the MA representation $x_t = \sum_{j=0}^{\infty} c_j \epsilon_{t-j}$ of this AR(3) process.

[6]

(vi) Suppose that $x_1, \ldots, x_n$ is a time series from an invertible MA(1) process $x_t = \epsilon_t + b_1\epsilon_{t-1}$, where ϵ_t is white noise. Suppose also that the estimator of the mean of the time series is $\bar{X}_n = 3.86$ and the estimator of the covariance function is $\hat{R}(0) = 6.8$ and $\hat{R}(1) = 2.8$. Estimate parameters of this process: the coefficient b_1 and the noise variance $\sigma^2 = \mathrm{Var}(\epsilon_t)$.

[4]

(vii) Find values of the parameter c such that the stochastic process x_t satisfying

$$x_t = x_{t-1} + 4cx_{t-4} - 4cx_{t-5} + \varepsilon_t, \quad t = 0, \pm 1, \ldots,$$

is stationary and values of c when x_t is non-stationary, where ϵ_t is a white noise process with $\mathrm{E}[\epsilon_t] = 0$ and $\mathrm{Var}\,[\epsilon_t] = \sigma_\epsilon^2$.

[4]

Question 3

(i) Give the definition of an invertible ARMA(p, q) process with zero mean.

[2]

(ii) Consider the stationary in wide sense process x_t with the covariance function $R(t)$. Show that $|R(t)| \leq R(0)$ and $R(-t) = R(t)$.

[2]

(iii) Write the R code for computing and depicting the correlogram for the time series: 5, 1, 7, 4, 4, 2, 8, 3, 3, 6.

[3]

(iv) Find a difference equation of the ARMA model for which the correlation function $\rho(k)$ is such that $\rho(1) = 2/3$, $\rho(2) = 2/9$ and $\rho(k) = 0$ for $k = 3, 4, \ldots$.

[6]

(v) Let a process x_t satisfy $x_t - 1.2x_{t-1} + 0.3x_{t-2} = \epsilon_t + 0.7\epsilon_{t-1} - 0.8\epsilon_{t-2}$, where ϵ_t is white noise, $t \in \mathbb{Z}$. Identify if x_t is invertible or not. Give a reason for your answer.

[2]

(vi) A company produces and sells digital thermometers. Sales of devices (in units of 100) over the past 12 weeks are $x_1, \ldots, x_{12}$ with $x_{12} = 14.1$. The company believes that the AR(1) process $x_t - 11 = 0.9(x_{t-1} - 11) + \epsilon_t$, $t \in \mathbb{Z}$, where ϵ_t is Gaussian white noise with zero mean and variance 1.96, is relevant for forecasting. Forecast sales for weeks 13, 14, 15, and 16 and give an expression for the confidence interval of future sales with confidence level $1 - \alpha$.

[4]

(vii) Find the variance and correlation function of the AR(2) process $x_t = 0.8x_{t-1} - 0.3x_{t-2} + \epsilon_t$, $t \in \mathbb{Z}$, where ϵ_t is white noise with zero mean and variance $\sigma^2 = 1.8$, using Yule-Walker equations.

[6]

Question 4

(i) Give the definition of short-range and long-range covariance functions.

[2]

(ii) Derive the explicit form of the correlation function of the AR(2) process.

[5]

(iii) Write a function in the R package for simulating and depicting a realization of length N from the AR(p) process with the vector of coefficients $a = (a_1, \ldots, a_p)$, the variance of white noise σ^2 and initial values $v = (x_1, \ldots, x_p)$.

[3]

(iv) Let a process x_t satisfy $x_t + 0.5x_{t-1} + 0.9x_{t-2} = \epsilon_t - 1.4\epsilon_{t-1}$, where ϵ_t is white noise, $t \in \mathbb{Z}$. Identify if x_t is causal or not. Give a reason for your answer.

[2]

(v) Sketch the temporal and spectral representations of realizations of two stochastic processes $x_k = 2\sin(2\pi k/9) + \epsilon_k$ and $y_k = \sin(2\pi k/18) + 2\varepsilon_k$, where ϵ_k and ε_k are white noise with mean 0 and variance 1. Explain any differences in your sketches.

[3]

(vi) Suppose that the average precipitation in Singapore in successive months was approximated by the AR(2) process $x_t - 25 = 0.8(x_{t-1} - 25) - 0.4(x_{t-2} - 25) + \epsilon_t$, where ϵ_t is Gaussian white noise with zero mean and variance 2.9. Suppose that the last successive observations are 23, 28, 22, 19. Find the predictions for the next two months, the mean square error of predictors, and the confidence intervals with confidence level $1-\alpha$.

[5]

(vii) Consider the stochastic process x_t defined by

$$x_t = 1 + \xi\cos(\lambda t - \eta),\ t = 0, \pm 1, \ldots,$$

where ξ is a random variable with zero mean and unit variance, η is a random variable with a uniform distribution on the interval $[-\pi, \pi]$ independent of ξ, and λ is a positive number. Show that this process is stationary in the wide sense. Find the covariance function of the process x_t.

[5]